



Phishing Awareness Training

Know the tactics. Recognize the signs. Protect yourself and your organization.

The Scale of the Threat

893M

**Phishing Attempts
Blocked**

Blocked by Kaspersky in 2024
alone — a 26% surge from 2023.

+182%

Rise Since 2021

Reported phishing reached nearly
two million attacks — up over
180% in three years.

60s

Seconds to Click

The median time before a user
clicks a phishing link and submits
their information.



How Phishing Works: The Three Ingredients



Trusted Identity

Impersonates a company, executive, or service you already know and trust.



Urgency

Creates pressure — overdue invoice, suspended account, or missed delivery.



Single Action

Click a link, open an attachment, scan a QR code, or reply with your info.



Red Flags in Phishing Emails

Urgent or Threatening Language

Demands for immediate action designed to short-circuit your judgment.

Requests for Sensitive Info

Passwords, credit cards, or personal details — legitimate senders never ask.

Suspicious Sender Address

Watch for subtle typos like "amazan.com" instead of "amazon.com".

Sketchy or Shortened URLs

Links that don't match the company name or hide behind URL shorteners.

Unexpected Attachments

Invoices or files you never requested are a classic delivery method.



Quiz: Spot the Red Flags

Which of these is a phishing red flag?

A

Email from your bank asking you to "**verify your account**" with a link

B

Invoice from a vendor you regularly work with

C

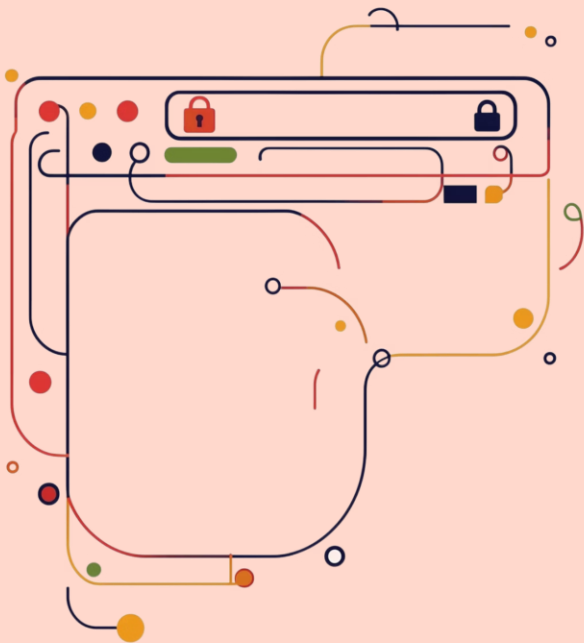
Meeting invitation from your manager

D

Password reset confirmation you requested



Answer: A — Legitimate banks never ask you to verify accounts via email links. Always go directly to the bank's official website by typing the URL yourself.



Spotting Fake Websites



Check the URL

Look for subtle misspellings or unusual domain extensions that mimic real brands.



Verify HTTPS

Legitimate sites use secure connections — look for the padlock icon in your browser.



Inspect Logos

Fake sites often have blurry or poorly copied branding — compare carefully.



Hover Before You Click

Hover over links to reveal the actual destination URL before committing to a click.



Quiz: Fake Website Challenge

You receive an email from "**PayPal**" with a link. What should you do?

A

Click the link and log in to check your account

B

Hover over the link to see the actual URL before clicking

C

Call PayPal's official number to verify before clicking

D

Both B and C



Answer: D

Always verify the URL by hovering first — and contact the company directly using a known phone number or by navigating to their official website yourself. Never trust a link in an unsolicited email.

Social Engineering Tactics



Impersonation

Pretending to be IT support, HR, or a trusted vendor to gain your confidence.



Authority

Using executive names or official-sounding language to pressure you into acting fast.



Scarcity

"Limited time offer" or "Act now or lose access" — manufactured urgency is a weapon.



Personalization

Using your name, job title, or company details to make the attack feel legitimate.



Quiz: Social Engineering Scenario

An email claims to be from your **CEO** requesting an urgent wire transfer. What's the best response?

1 Process the transfer immediately — it's from the CEO

Never act on financial requests without independent verification, regardless of who they appear to be from.

2 Contact your CEO directly through a known phone number to verify

Always verify urgent requests independently — especially any involving money or sensitive data.

3 Forward it to accounting without checking

Forwarding without verification only passes the risk along — never skip the check.

4 Delete it without responding

Reporting it to IT is better than deleting — it helps protect your whole organization.



✓ Answer: B — Always verify urgent requests independently, especially financial ones. This is a classic CEO impersonation (BEC) tactic.



Best Practices to Stay Safe

01

Verify Sender Identity

Contact them directly through known channels — not by replying to the suspicious email.

02

Don't Click or Download Blindly

Never click links or open attachments from emails you weren't expecting.

03

Use Strong Passwords + MFA

Use unique passwords for every account and enable multi-factor authentication everywhere.

04

Report Suspicious Emails

Alert your IT or Security team immediately — your report could protect your colleagues.

05

Keep Everything Updated

Software and security tools with the latest patches close the doors attackers exploit.

What to Do If You Fall for It

It happens to everyone. What matters most is **how fast you respond**.

Report Immediately

Tell your IT or Security team right away — every minute counts.

Change Your Password

If you entered credentials, update them immediately from a secure device.

Monitor Your Accounts

Watch for suspicious activity across email, banking, and work systems.

Enable Fraud Alerts

If financial info was compromised, contact your bank and set up fraud protection.

Don't Panic

Quick, calm action limits the damage. You've got this — and your team has your back.